

Security breach At Opera

Opera's internal network was attacked by hackers resulting in the spread of malware
<http://dgit.in/16Elip2>



New Firefox logo

Firefox rolled out its new updated logo with Firefox 23 beta for desktop. Details have been removed and it appears smoother

A watchful eye

We take a look at the various developments in the month gone by that have the potential to affect our privacy and security

Google Glass films its first arrest

A scuffle at the New Jersey Boardwalk on the 4th of July has revealed just how easy it is to film and photograph with Google Glass, something that could be unnerving to many, and equally good for some, as showed by this recent event.



Filmed on Google Glass

Chris Barnett, a slightly more than average American (simply because he owns a pair of Google Glass) was walking at the New Jersey Boulevard, where many had gathered to celebrate the 237th anniversary of being an independent nation, when he heard a fight breaking out. Curious as any by-stander would be, Chris moved in closer to the commotion than most photographers would have been able to with their bulky cameras.

What stands out here is just how easy it was to film the whole thing without ringing any alarm bells. If you look at the video closely for a second time, you'll realize that he just waltzed onto the scene of the crime and filmed it the way he was looking at it. This opens up many opportunities, for voyeurs and journalists alike. Are we comfortable with and ready for such devices?

Bug affecting "99%" of Android devices

Security researchers from Bluebox Labs have claimed that they've discovered a four-year-old Android bug that could be exploited by malware to disguise themselves as verified apps and take over a user's device. The researchers claim that the bug allows malicious software to change the code of an APK file without leaving evidence, which means that all that a user will have to do to be affected is install the app on a device.

The Bluebox team says that the bug has existed since Android 1.6 (Donut). However, a hacker can't distribute the modified app through Google Play as the app store has been patched to verify the contents of all apps downloaded. It still appears to be a serious problem because installing apps from third-party sources, where security measures can be lax, is quite popular among Android users. In fact, in the recent past, Facebook experimented with serving updates directly to Android devices without using the Play Store. Also, Android devices that haven't been updated are at risk of this vulnerability. Once the malware is installed using the bug, a hacker could take over the user's device, steal personal data or use the device as part of a botnet attack.

As The Verge points out, this seems to be of especially greater concern for Android users whose handsets have stopped receiving official updates. Jeff Forristal of Bluebox Labs has said that Google was informed

of the bug in February of this year but closing the security hole would be up to the manufacturers of individual Android handsets, "99%" of which could be affected. Forristal has revealed that the Samsung Galaxy S4 has already been patched but the Nexus devices have yet to receive the concerned security update.

If you have an Android handset make sure you have all the latest system and Play Store updates installed and also ensure that you only install apps from trusted sources.

Government unveils National Cyber Security Policy 2013

Aiming to provide a secure and robust cyberspace for Indian users including businesses and the government, the Indian Government unveiled the National Cyber Security Policy 2013.

Announcing the new policy, Minister of Communications and IT Kapil Sibal said: "...policy is a framework document and it gives you a broad outline of what our vision is...the real task or the challenge is the operationalization of this policy."



The policy aims to protect



The Dirty Dozen rating by population

According to Sibal, the policy was necessary to bring stability in cyber space, especially for the critical infrastructure such as air defence, power, nuclear and telecommunications.

The minister said the policy would help the government tackle cyber attacks from state and non-state actors, corporates and terrorists.

India 6th spam-relaying nation

Sophos has released its latest 'Dirty Dozen' of spam relaying nations, covering the Q2 (April to June) of 2013. The U.S. continues to be the top spam-spewing country followed by Belarus at the second position. The list of top 12 nations has three new nations: Ukraine, Kazakhstan and Argentina; while France, Peru and South Korea have exited from the Dirty Dozen list. India has slipped to sixth position from the third spot in the previous list.

Sophos says it's no surprise to see India and China in the Dirty Dozen, considering the massive population and ever-increasing demand for the internet connectivity.